Writing Technique (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Example — Combining Techniques: Rewrite 'The wind was strong. It was cold too.' using a fronted adverbial AND a stronger verb.

Answer: e.g. 'Howling in from the north, the wind bit at our faces.' (Accept any answer combining a fronted adverbial with a precise, vivid verb.)

Quick Practice (15 questions)

1. Identify the sentence opener type: "Without a sound, the cat slipped through the gap." A) adverb opener B) prepositional phrase opener C) -ing opener D) subordinate clause opener E) pronoun opener
2. Replace "walked" with a stronger verb to suggest someone moving carefully and quietly.
3. Which sentence "shows" sadness rather than "telling" it? A) Lily was sad. B) Lily felt very sad indeed. C) Lily's eyes brimmed with tears as she stared at the floor. D) Lily was an unhappy girl. E) Lily was feeling down that day.
4. Select ALL that apply: which of these are cohesive devices that show ADDITION of an idea? A) In addition, ... B) However, ... C) Furthermore, ... D) On the other hand, ... E) As well as this, ...
5. Identify the weak adjective in "It was a nice day for a good walk" and suggest one stronger replacement for it.
6. "Crash! The shelf came down." What effect does the short exclamatory opener "Crash!" create?
7. Which connective best links these two ideas to show a reason? "Hannah missed the bus. ___, she was late for school." A) However B) Meanwhile C) As a result D) Similarly E) Although
8. Rewrite "The dog ran fast." using a stronger verb than "ran".
9. Select ALL that apply: which sentences use a fronted adverbial correctly (with a comma after the opening phrase)? A) In the distance, thunder rumbled. B) In the distance thunder rumbled. C) Yesterday, we visited the museum. D) Yesterday we visited, the museum. E) Carefully, she lifted the vase.
10. Identify which word is repeated too often in this sentence and should be varied: "The big dog ran to the big tree near the big fence."
11. Which sentence below best demonstrates "show, don't tell" for excitement? A) Tom was excited about the trip. B) Tom felt very excited. C) Tom packed his bag three days early and checked it every hour. D) Tom was looking forward to it. E) Tom was an excited boy.
12. Add a suitable cohesive word to link: "It began to snow heavily. ___, the school decided to close early." A) Although B) Consequently C) Meanwhile D) Similarly E) Otherwise
13. Rewrite this sentence so it opens with an -ing clause: "The waves crashed against the rocks, sending spray high into the air."
14. Select ALL that apply: which words below are strong, specific verbs rather than weak, general ones? A) dashed B) went C) demolished D) did E) whispered
15. Identify the cohesive device and its function in: "The museum was closing soon. Nevertheless, Grandad insisted on seeing every exhibit."

Mixed Practice (15 questions)

1. Rewrite "He was angry." as a showing sentence using a physical action (do not use the word "angry").

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2. Combine these two sentences using a connective that shows contrast: "The team trained hard all season. They lost the final."

3. Which rewrite best varies this repetitive paragraph's openers? "Sam ran to the shop. Sam bought some milk. Sam ran home again." A) Sam ran to the shop, Sam bought milk, and Sam ran home. B) Running to the shop, Sam bought some milk, then dashed home again. C) Sam, who ran to the shop, bought milk, and Sam ran home. D) To the shop Sam ran, and milk Sam bought, and home Sam ran. E) Sam ran, Sam bought, Sam ran.

4. Rewrite "The food was delicious." as a showing sentence appealing to taste or smell.

5. Select ALL that apply: which of the following successfully use varied sentence length for effect? A) A long descriptive sentence followed immediately by a two-word sentence for impact. B) Three sentences of exactly the same length and structure in a row. C) A short question followed by a longer explanatory answer. D) Repeating "and" to join five ideas into one sentence. E) A single-word sentence used to mark a sudden change.

6. Identify and improve the weak verb(s) in: "She got the trophy and put it on the shelf."

7. Add a fronted adverbial of your own choice to the start of this sentence: "the fireworks lit up the sky."

8. Which connective best completes this sentence to show a similarity? "Owls hunt silently at night. ___, cats can move without making a sound." A) However B) Similarly C) Therefore D) Although E) Otherwise

9. Rewrite this flat description to "show" boredom instead of telling it: "The lesson was boring and everyone was bored."

10. Select ALL that apply: which of these are effective cohesive devices linking across paragraphs? A) Having explored the causes, we can now consider the effects. B) Then stuff happened. C) Turning now to the second argument, ... D) Also, there's that. E) Building on this point, ...

11. Rewrite "The storm was loud and scary" to show, not tell, using at least one sound detail.

12. Identify the type of opener in "Carefully, Noah lifted the sleeping kitten." and rewrite the sentence using a DIFFERENT type of opener, keeping the same meaning.

13. Which sentence combines a strong verb AND a cohesive device most effectively? A) The flames devoured the barn; consequently, the farmer lost everything. B) The flames were big and the farmer lost stuff. C) The barn burned and the farmer was sad about it. D) There was a fire and then things were lost. E) The farmer's barn, which burned down, caused him to lose things.

14. Rewrite "I was tired." as two sentences: a longer one giving physical detail, then a short one for effect.

15. Select ALL that apply: which weak words below should usually be replaced with more precise alternatives in descriptive writing? A) nice B) shimmering C) good D) devastating E) big

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. "Nice" appears three times in a short paragraph about a nice day at a nice beach with nice weather. Name the problem AND the best general fix, in one sentence.

2. Rewrite "It was dark." as a single showing sentence that also uses a fronted adverbial.

3. In one sentence, link these two ideas with a connective that shows a result, AND use a stronger verb than "went": "The tide went out quickly. The rock pools were exposed."

4. Turn "She was brave." into a single showing sentence that also varies the usual Subject-first opener.

5. Identify BOTH the weak verb and the missing cohesive link in this sentence, then rewrite it in one improved sentence: "He went to the door and he said something quiet."

6. A paragraph reads: "The explorers walked through the jungle. It was hot. It was hard. Bugs were everywhere. They were tired." Rewrite this whole paragraph (4-6 sentences) so that it: uses at least one fronted adverbial, varies sentence length with at least one short sentence for effect, replaces at least two weak verbs/adjectives with stronger choices, and uses one cohesive device to link two of the sentences.

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7. Explain, using an example, how combining a fronted adverbial with a strong verb can make an action sentence more powerful than a plain Subject-Verb-Object sentence.

8. A student's paragraph begins every sentence with "I". Rewrite these three sentences using three DIFFERENT opener types (not Subject-first), keeping the same basic meaning: "I opened the box carefully. I found an old photograph inside. I felt a lump in my throat."

9. Rewrite this passage to improve cohesion between its two sentences AND replace the weak adjective "bad": "The weather was bad all week. The sports day had to happen."

10. Explain why ending a tense paragraph with a very short sentence (such as "He was gone.") is usually more effective than ending with a long, detailed sentence, referring to pacing in your answer.

11. Rewrite the following overly "told" paragraph as a "shown" one, using sensory detail and action instead of naming emotions directly (aim for 3-4 sentences): "Zara was excited and nervous before the performance. She was also a bit scared she would forget her lines."

12. Combine the following three short sentences into one well-varied sentence, then explain which single word you chose as the strongest verb and why: "The wave rose. The wave crashed onto the shore. The wave pulled back."

13. A paragraph overuses "and": "The fire spread and the smoke rose and the alarm rang and everyone left." Rewrite it using at least two different sentence lengths, replacing at least one "and" with a more precise connective, and improving at least one weak verb.

14. Explain the difference in effect between these two versions, referring to specific techniques by name: A) "The old man was sad and lonely." B) "The old man sat alone at the window, watching other families pass by outside."

15. Write one sentence about a sudden storm at sea that uses ALL FOUR of the following together: a fronted adverbial opener, a strong/precise verb, show-don't-tell (no naming of an emotion), and is followed immediately by a short sentence of two to four words for effect.

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